Criterion 1: Central Idea & Restatement (RACE "R" & "A") • **Standards Alignment:** RL.9-10.2 / RI.9-10.2 (Determine central idea, summarize key details) or RL.11-12.2 / RI.11-12.2	
4 **Exceeds**	Clearly restates the prompt in a complete sentence and directly answers the question with a precise, accurate central idea.
3 **Meets**	Restates the prompt and answers the question, though the central idea may be slightly basic or missing minor precision.
2 **Developing**	Attempts to answer the prompt, but omits the restatement OR the answer is vague, incomplete, or partially inaccurate.
1 **Emerging**	Writes an answer that is off-topic, incomplete, or requires significant teacher prompting to state a clear answer.
0	No response provided or completely off-task.

Criterion 2: Text Evidence & Citation (RACE "C" & "E") • **Standards Alignment:** RL.9-10.1 / RI.9-10.1 (Cite strong and thorough textual evidence) or RL.11-12.1 / RI.11-12.1	
4 **Exceeds**	Cites relevant, specific text evidence using a clear citation starter (e.g., *"The author states..."*) AND clearly explains how the detail supports the answer with chronological retelling of major themes.
3 **Meets**	Cites relevant text evidence, but the citation phrase is missing OR the explanation of how it supports the answer is minimal, OR the events are not retold in sequential order.
2 **Developing**	Includes a detail from the text, but it is incomplete, misquoted, unaligned to the prompt, or lacks an explanation.
1 **Emerging**	References the text in a general way without citing specific evidence, or relies entirely on personal opinion.
0	No text evidence provided.

Criterion 3: Conventions & Mechanics (COPS) • **Standards Alignment:** L.9-10.1 / L.9-10.2 (Demonstrate command of standard English grammar, capitalization, and punctuation)	
4 **Exceeds**	Writing demonstrates strong control of conventions with minimal errors in capitalization, punctuation, and spelling that do not interfere with meaning.
3 **Meets**	Writing contains 1–3 minor mechanics errors (e.g., missing end punctuation or a lowercase "I"), but meaning remains clear.

2 Developing	Writing contains frequent mechanics errors that noticeably distract the reader or make sentences difficult to decode.
1 Emerging	Writing lacks basic sentence structure, capitalization, or punctuation throughout (e.g., run-ons, fragment strings).
0	Insufficient writing to evaluate conventions.

Criterion 4: Task Initiation & Behavior (Dojo Alignment) • **Standards Alignment:** IEP Behavioral / Executive Functioning Goals (Task Initiation, On-Task Behavior, Self-Advocacy)	
4 **Exceeds**	Initiates task within 2 minutes of direction, stays on task throughout the writing block, and utilizes self-advocacy tools (e.g., Help Cards) appropriately.
3 **Meets**	Initiates task within 2–4 minutes following 1 verbal redirect; stays on task for the majority of the block.
2 **Developing**	Requires multiple teacher redirects to begin or sustain writing; displays frequent off-task behaviors before starting.
1 **Emerging**	Refuses or fails to initiate task until individual teacher conference/intervention occurs late in the block.
0	Complete refusal to participate.